



Fighting the propaganda war

Actress and activist Jane Fonda delivers an antiwar message on Hanoi Radio in North Vietnam in July 1972. Exploiting the propaganda value of Fonda's visit to the full, Hanoi got her to sit on an anti-aircraft gun while she made the broadcast.

Reaching out

Strategy in Washington in 1972, however, was not solely focused on Vietnam. As the war there dragged on, Nixon surprised the US public by visiting the People's Republic of China in February to normalize relations. Later that year, he visited the Soviet Union to pursue a détente. Both nations had previously supplied aid to Hanoi. Nixon's visits marked a shift in Cold War diplomacy.